

KYLE GRAYCAR

Champaign, IL · (650) 862-3306 · kgraycar@gmail.com · linkedin.com/in/kgraycar · graycar.consulting

About

Lifecycle and growth marketing leader with nearly a decade of experience building retention and engagement programs from scratch at high-growth consumer fintech and subscription platforms. Deep Braze practitioner with hands-on expertise in complex CRM campaign architecture, behavioral segmentation, push notification strategy, and experimentation programs that drive product adoption, revenue, and long-term engagement. Founding lifecycle hire mindset: I define the strategy, own the roadmap, build the infrastructure, and communicate results to leadership, with no established playbook to inherit. Fintech-native operator: built and launched a consumer financial app with Plaid and Stripe integrations, Boglehead investor, and daily Monarch personal finance subscriber who understands how financial behavior and habit formation drive retention.

Skills

Lifecycle & Retention: Braze (Canvases, Liquid, Segmentation, Custom Events, Connected Content, Agent Console), Retention and Engagement Strategy, Push Notifications, Email, In-App Messaging, Win-Back, Churn Reduction

Growth & Revenue: Revenue-Driven Lifecycle Programs, Product Adoption Campaigns, Behavioral Trigger Programs, Trading Activity Re-engagement, LTV Optimization, Cross-Sell and Upsell

Experimentation: A/B Testing, Holdout Groups, Incrementality Measurement, Experimentation Roadmaps, Data Science Partnership, Reforge Experimentation Certified

Analytics: SQL, Amplitude, Mixpanel, Cohort Analysis, Funnel Analysis, Retention Curve Analysis, Revenue Attribution

Fintech: Consumer Financial Products, Plaid Integration, Stripe Payments, Financial Behavior and Habit Formation, Regulated Communications

AI & Technical: Claude, Cursor, ChatGPT, Claude Code, HTML/CSS, Liquid, JSON, Python, JavaScript

Experience

Senior Lifecycle & Retention Lead · Brilliant.org · Remote

Aug 2024 – Jul 2026

- Established Brilliant.org's lifecycle marketing function as the founding hire, owning the full retention and engagement strategy end-to-end: defining success metrics, setting priorities, building the roadmap, and communicating results to product and growth leadership.
- Built and executed complex CRM campaigns and automations in Braze across push, email, and in-app to drive product adoption, revenue, and user engagement across 23M+ users and 30M+ monthly touchpoints.
- Drove the lifecycle experimentation roadmap in partnership with Data and Product: designed A/B tests with proper holdouts, measured incrementality, and scaled winning programs to unlock growth, contributing to a 5x DAU increase (20K to 100K) and 30%+ annual revenue growth.
- Built push notification opt-in programs and behavioral re-engagement campaigns that drove lapsed users back into active product usage; improved new user retention 100%+ within six months.

- Used Claude, Cursor, and ChatGPT daily to accelerate campaign execution, scale personalization, and extend what a founding lifecycle operator can produce without additional headcount.

Technical Product Marketing Consultant · Freelance · Remote *Oct 2021 – Aug 2024*

- Built lifecycle retention and engagement programs for consumer fintech and B2C clients including Kiva, Chegg, and Magoosh; owned strategy through execution with full accountability for business outcomes and upward communication of results.

Co-Founder & CEO · Decarbon · Remote *Oct 2021 – Aug 2024*

- Founded a consumer fintech platform integrating Plaid (financial data) and Stripe (payments); built retention and engagement programs from scratch and led a cross-functional team from zero to 5,000 users.

Product Marketing Manager · Magoosh · Berkeley, CA *Oct 2019 – Oct 2021*

- Drove 15% annual sales growth, increasing ARR from \$15M to \$17.5M; managed Braze and Intercom lifecycle platforms across ~10M profiles, building complex CRM campaigns, behavioral segmentation, and experimentation programs that drove product adoption and revenue.
- Partnered with Product and Data Science on experimentation strategy; pulled own SQL to analyze cohort retention, measure revenue attribution, and communicate results to leadership.

Head of Marketing · Electrum · Los Angeles, CA *Sep 2016 – Oct 2019*

- Built retention and growth marketing programs from scratch at a consumer marketplace, scaling from \$1M to \$2M ARR; owned push, email, and SMS channels with direct revenue accountability and a \$20K/week paid media budget.

Teaching Fellow · Teach For China · Yunnan, China *Jul 2014 – Feb 2016*

- Taught English to 400+ students in rural southwest China; led the Fellows Advisory Council for cohort professional development.



Education

B.S. Environmental Science · UCLA *Los Angeles, CA*

Outstanding Service Award, Institute of Environment and Sustainability



Certifications

- Experimentation Program · Reforge
- LEED Green Associate · U.S. Green Building Council